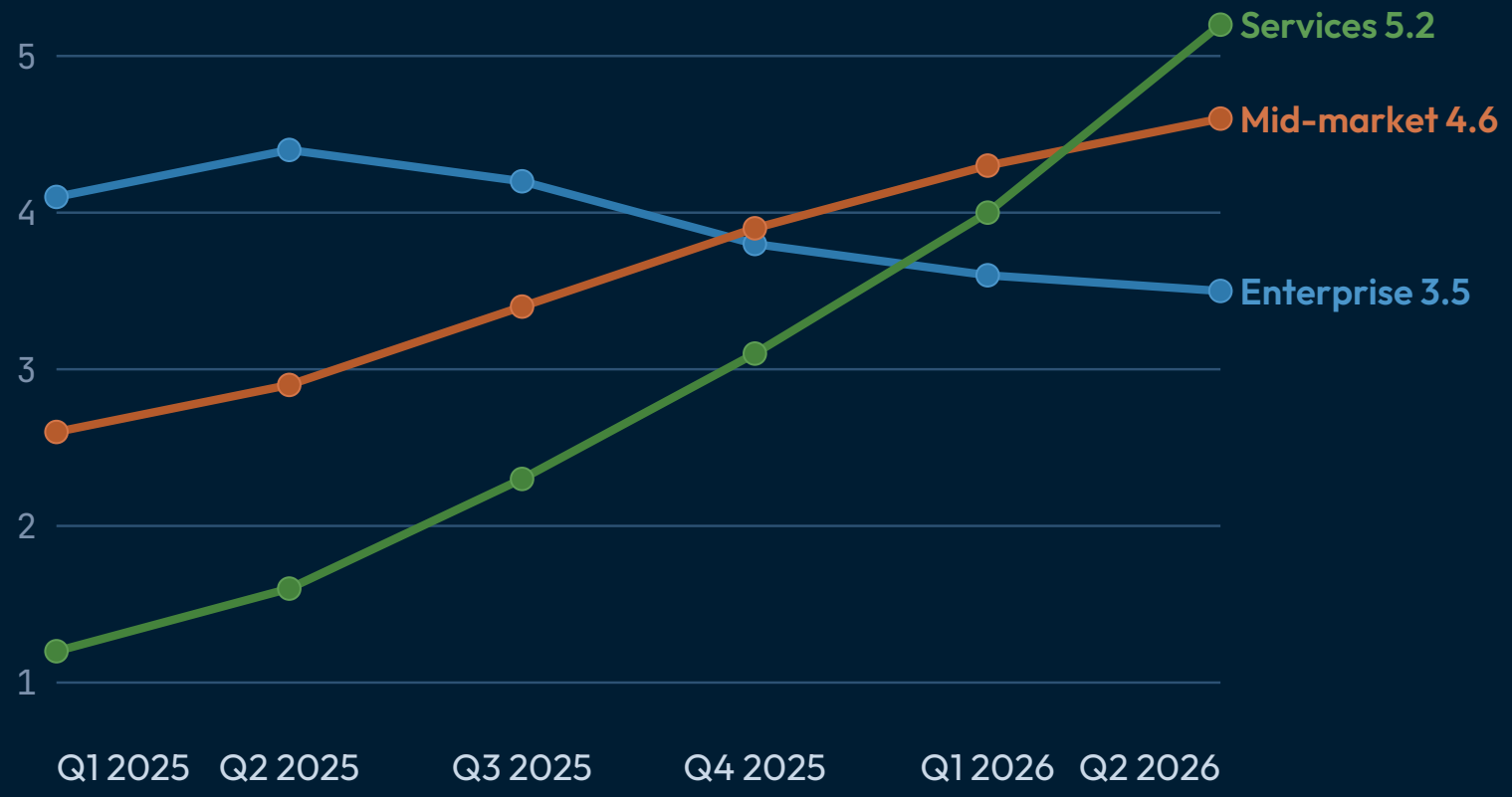
EVIDENCE · CANVAS · SERIES

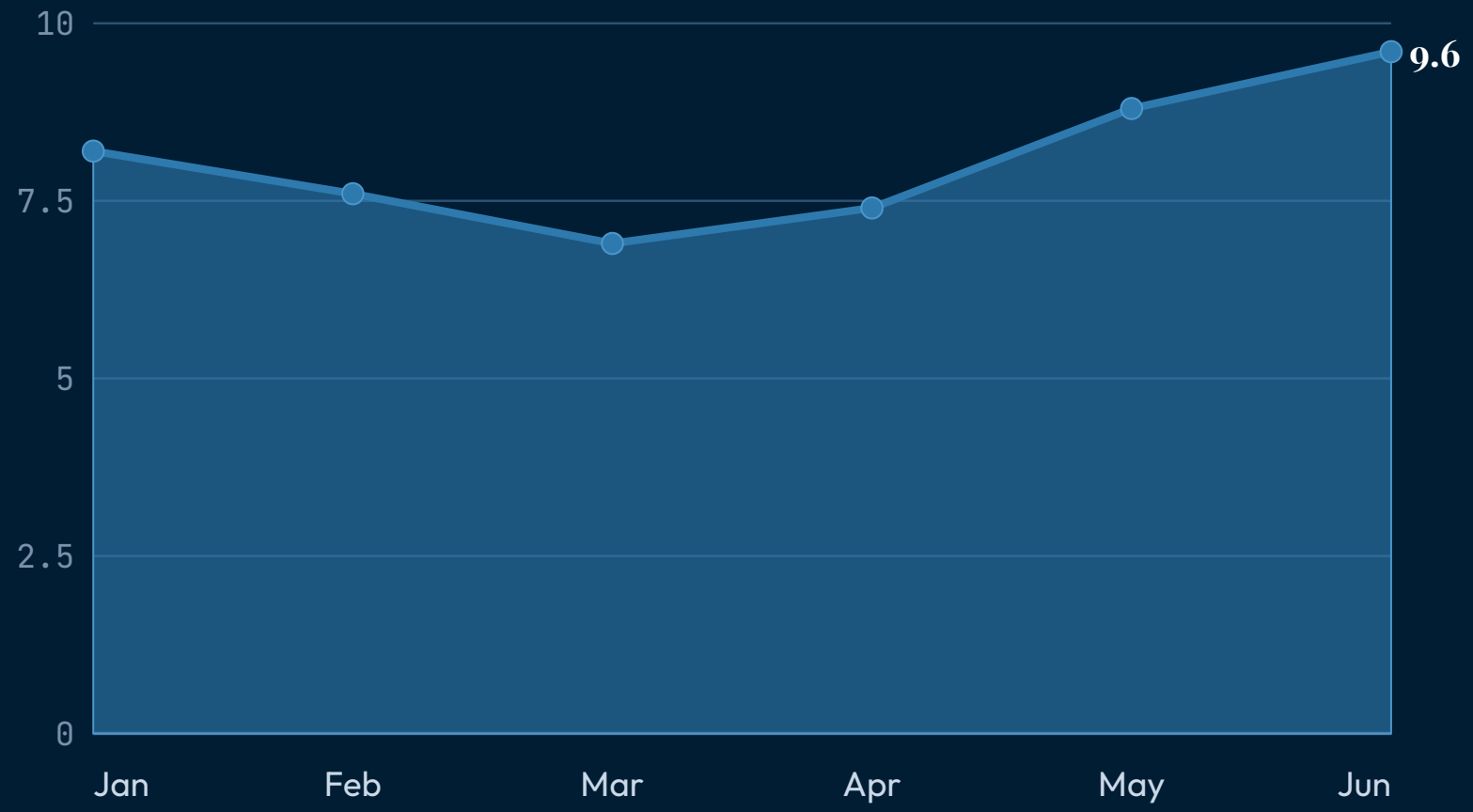
line

A measure plotted across an ordered axis, so the movement is the read — one line or several, optionally filled, stacked, or stepped.

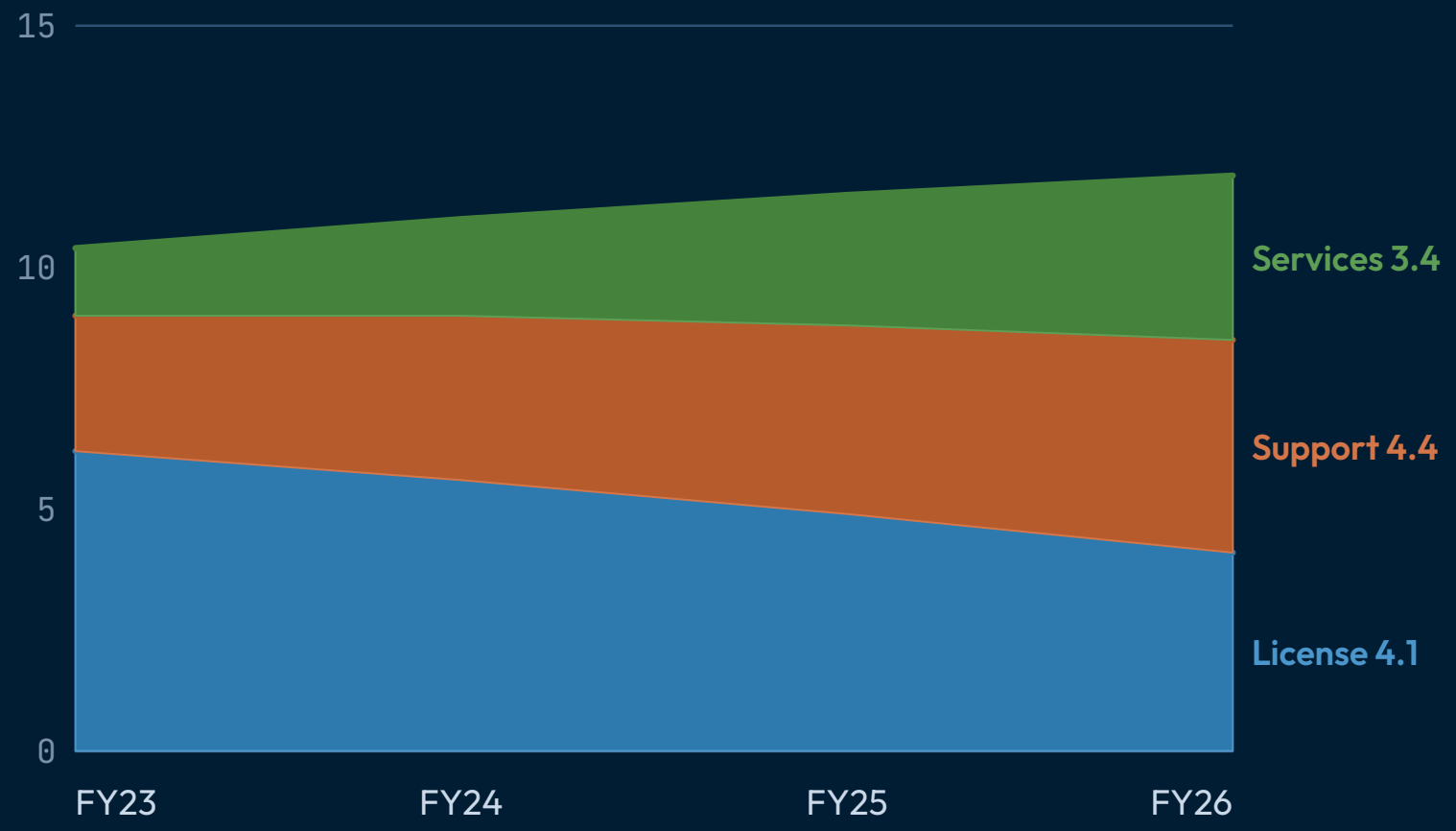
Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



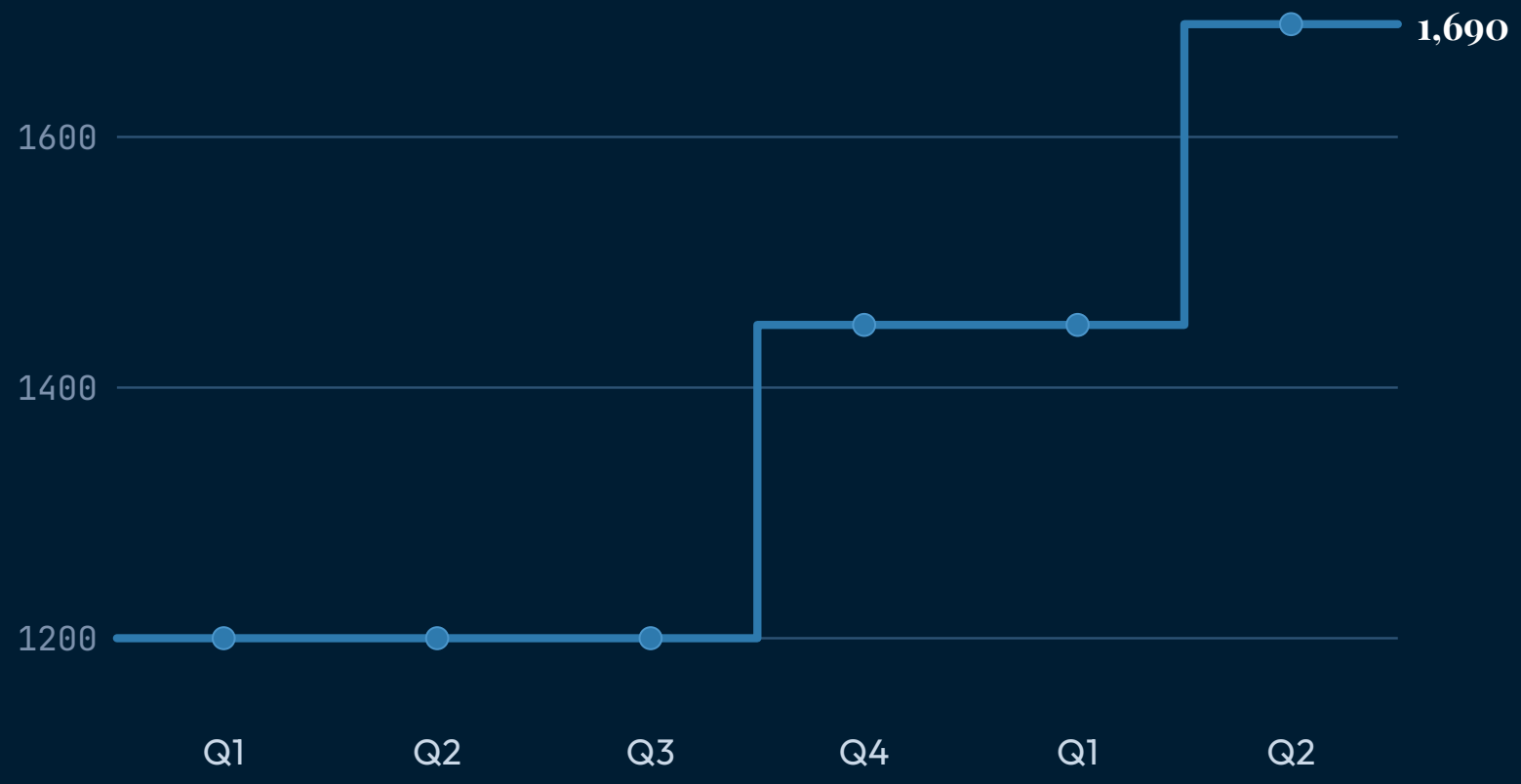
Cash on hand never dipped below one quarter of runway.



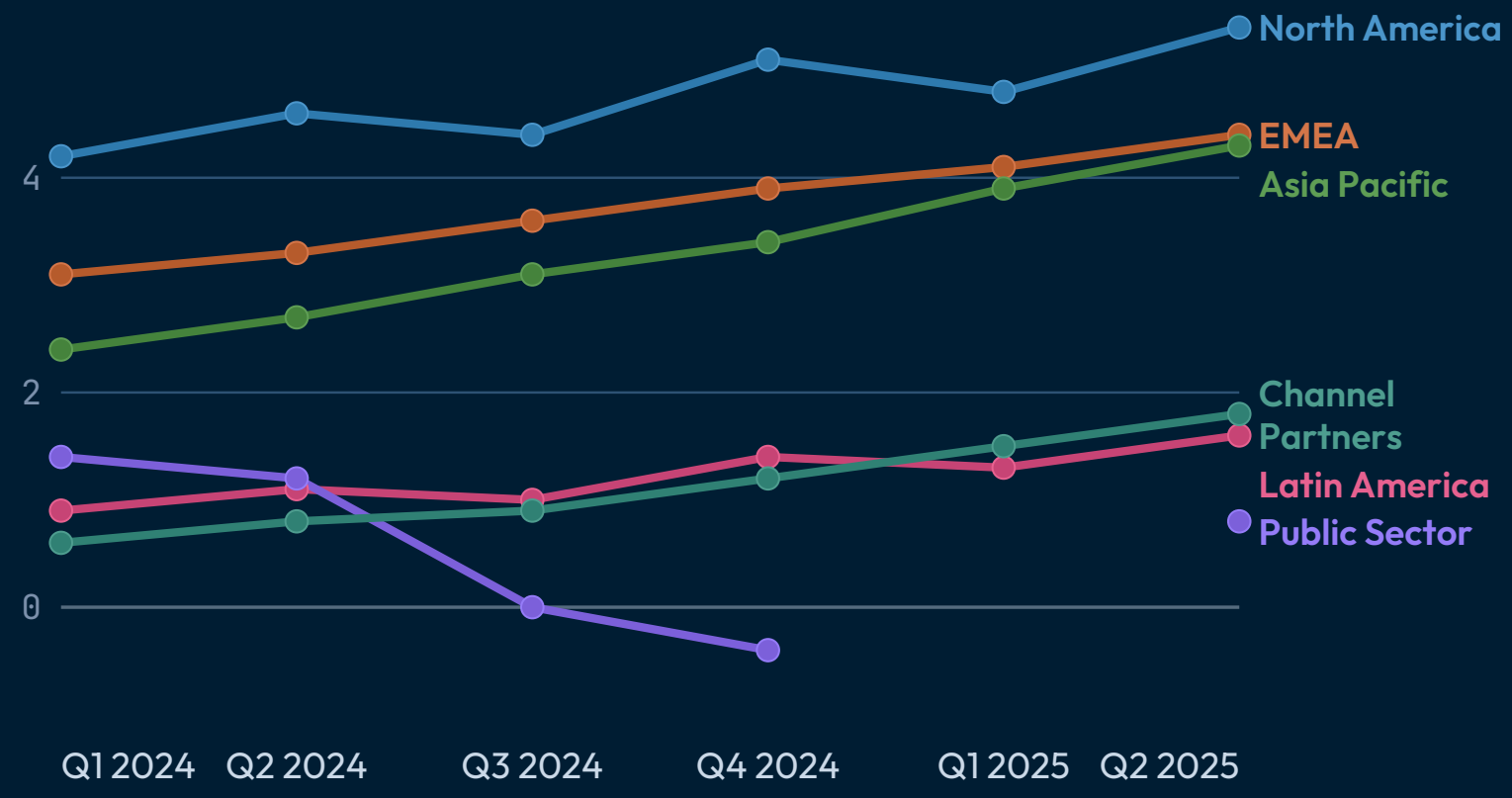
The mix shifted; the total barely moved.



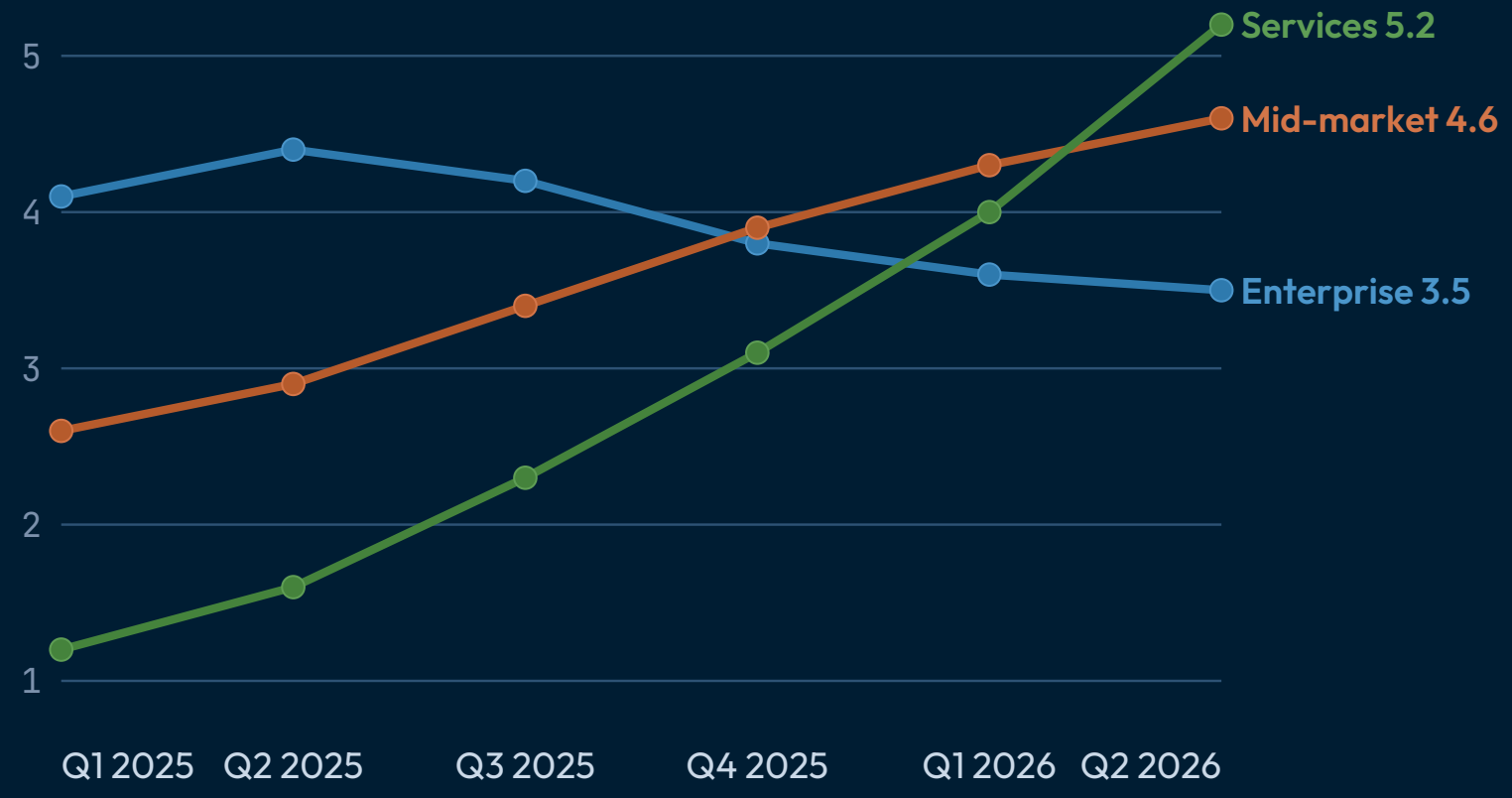
The list price held for three quarters, then moved twice.



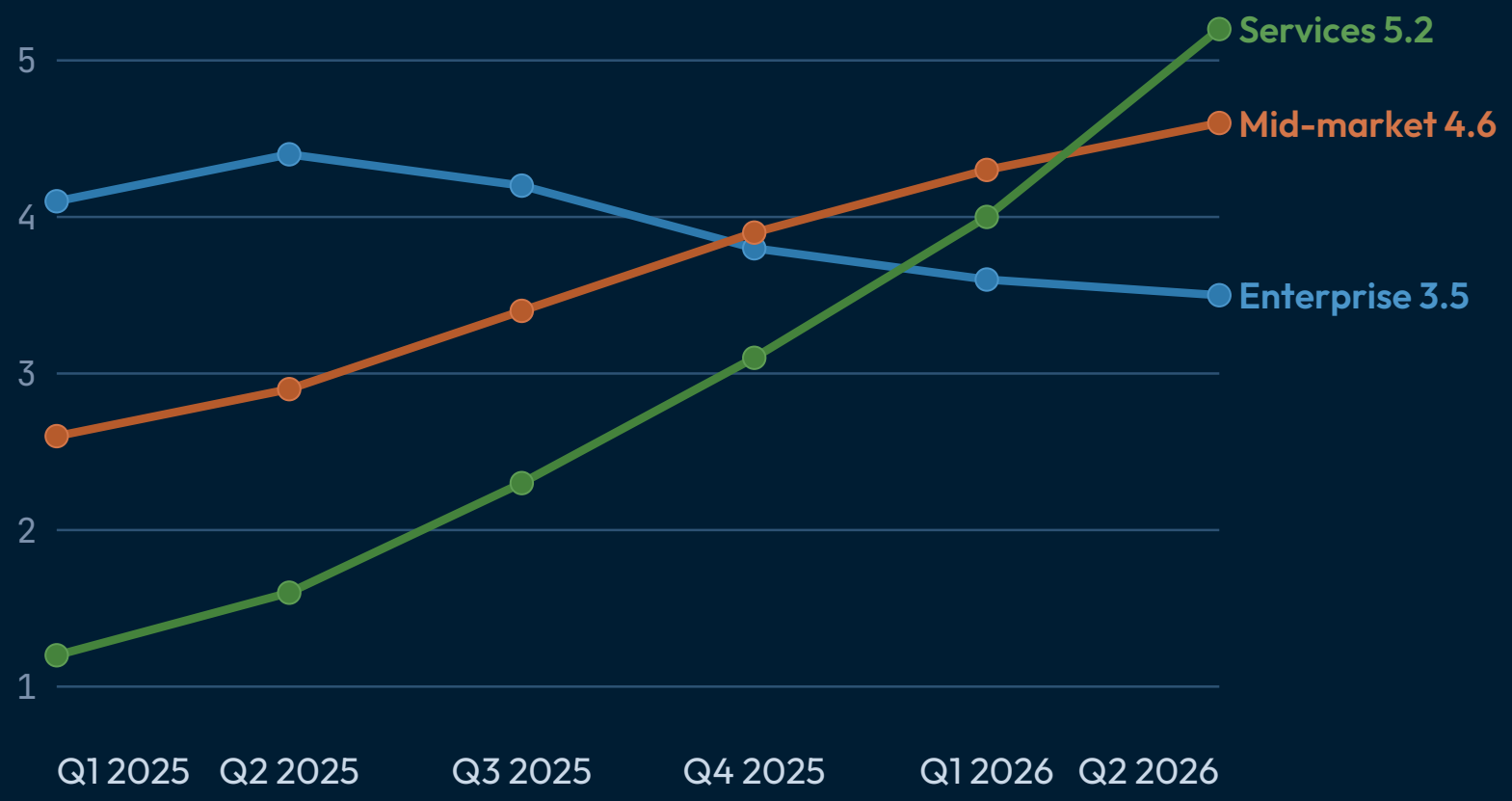
Six lines, six quarters, one hole and one loss.



Services grew into the gap enterprise left.

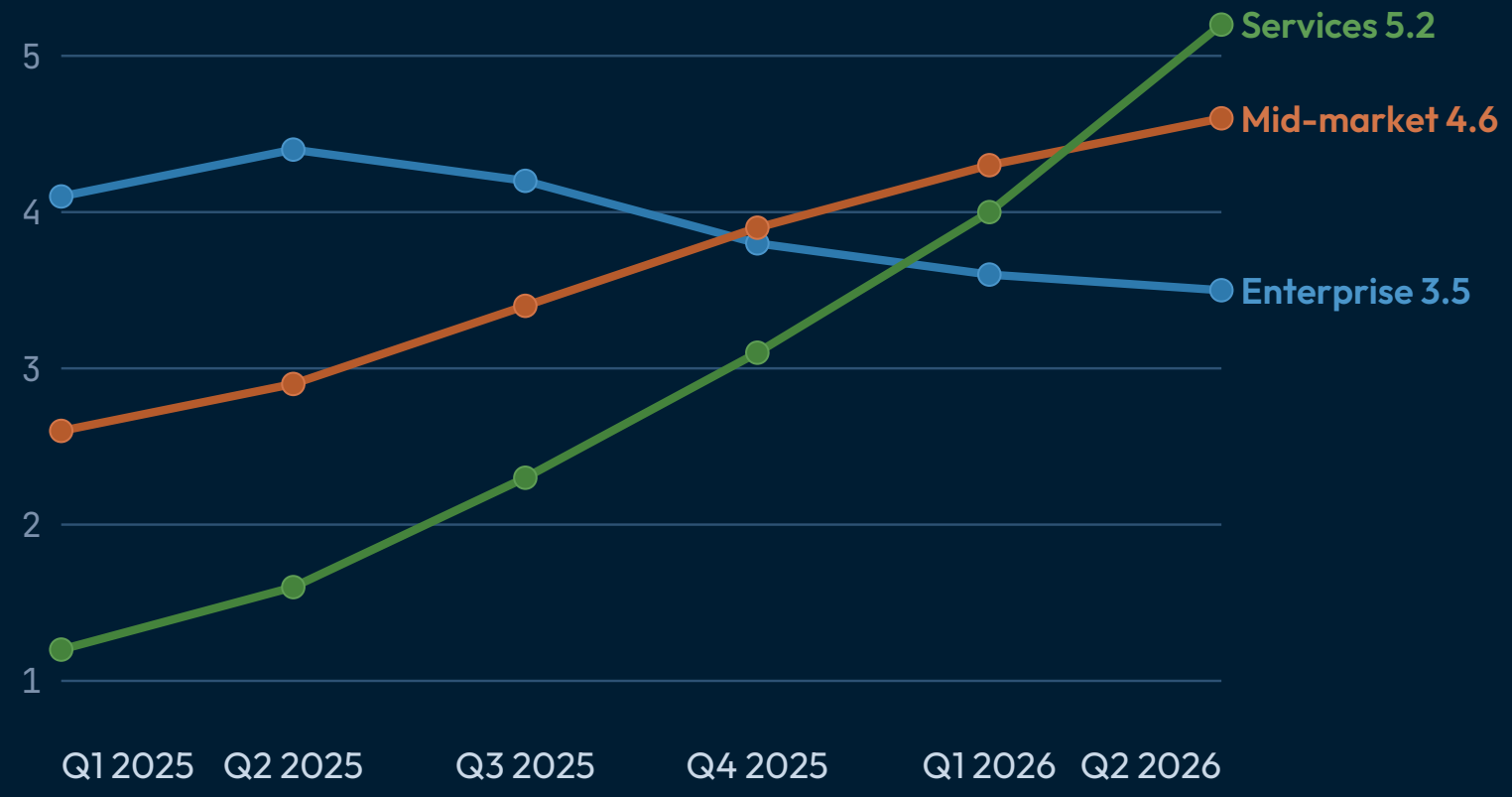


Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



Composition: compact · line compact

Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



When NOT to reach for line.

Two points

Two points are a slope, and `slope` draws it better. Note it is authored transposed: one bullet per entity, its two points nested.

Categories that are not ordered

Joining 'Legal, Finance, Sales, Ops' asserts a progression that does not exist. Use `bar`, or `stacked-bar` if each one decomposes.

When NOT to reach for line.

A filled area for several series

Two opaque regions hide each other. Use `stacked-area` when the series sum to a total; the kernel drops the fill rather than lie.

A trend where the story is attainment against a target

If the question is 'did we hit the number', the target is not on the line. `bullet` puts actual, target and a band on one row.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`bar` — the categories are unordered and the claim is magnitude, not movement

`slope` — there are exactly two points and the story is which entities changed rank

`stacked-bar` — each period decomposes into parts and the periods are compared, not connected

`bullet` — the number is read against a target and a qualitative band, not against its own past

`gantt` — the horizontal axis is real dates carrying durations rather than an ordered set of measurements